MEDIEVAL HISTORY

Direction: The following 15 (fifteen) items consist of two statements, one labelled as the Assertion '(A)' and the other as Reason '(R)'. You are to examine these two statements carefully and select the answers to these items using the code given below:

(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

7. Assertion (A) : Emperor Akbar marched towards Afghanistan in 1581 with a huge army:
Reason (R) : He was on his way to reclaim his ancestral country of Ferghana in Central Asia.
(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

Ans. (c) : Akbar marched towards Afghanistan in 1581 to conquer Kabul to expand his kingdom. R is incorrect as he had no intention to reclaim his ancestral country of Ferghana.

8. Assertion (A) : Shah Alam II spend the initial years as an Emperor far away from his capital.
Reason (R) : There was always a lurking danger of foreign invasion from the north-west frontier.
(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

Ans. (c) : Aligauhar ascended the throne of Shah Alam II after the assassination of Alamgir II by Wazir Imadulmulk in the course of the destabilization of the later Mughal rulers. He spent the initial years as an emperor away from his capital due to the fear of Najib Khan Rohila, who became very powerful in Delhi, and not due to forigh invasion. He was re-established in 1772 AD with the help of Mahadji Scindia. Finally after the Delhi victory in 1803 by the British, he was assassinated by Ghulam Qadir in 1806 AD.

9. Assertion (A) : Marathas emerged as the strongest native power in India after the decline of Mughal empire.
Reason (R) : Marathas were the first to have a clear concept of a united India nation.
(a) Both A and R are individually true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are individually true but R is NOT the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

Ans. (c) : Mughal empire declined due to misgovernance and foreign intruders like Britishers. During this period, Marathas resisted well and emerged as the strongest native power in India. Marathas never had the concept of a United Indian Nation. They are generally criticized for this reason.

10. Alam Khan, one of those who invited Babur to invade India was
(a) An uncle of Ibrahim Lodi and a pretender to the throne of Delhi.
(b) A cousin of Ibrahim Lodi who was ill-treated and expelled from the country.
(c) The father of Dilawar Khan to whom cruel treatment was meted out by Ibrahim Lodi.
(d) A high official in Punjab province who was very much discontented with Ibrahim Lodi's treatment to his tribe.

Ans. (a) : Babur fought three important battles in India viz, the battles of Panipat, Khanwa and Ghaghara and won all of them. He came to India from Ferghana to fight Ibrahim Lodi in the battle of Panipat and establish his rule in India. Due to disaffection with Ibrahim, Daula Khan Lodi along with the Ibrahim Lodi's own uncle, Alam Khan invited Babur to invade the kingdom.

11. The battle of Dharmat was fought between
(a) Muhammad Ghori and Jai Chand
(b) Babur and Afghans
(c) Aurangzeb and Dara Shikoh
(d) Ahmad Shah Durrani and the Marathas

Ans. (c) : The battle of Dharmat was fought between Aurangzeb and Dara Shikoh in 1658 for Shahjahan's throne. Dara Shikoh was defeated by Aurangzeb.

12. How did the Mughal Emperor Jahandarshah's reign come to an early end?
(a) He was deposed by is Wazir.
(b) He died due to a slip while climbing down steps.
(c) He was defeated by his nephew in a battle.
(d) He died of sickness due to too much consumption of wine.

Ans. (c) : Jahandarshah was defeated in the battle of Agra on 10 January, 1713 by Farrukhsiyar, his nephew and the second son of Azim-ush-Shan, with the support of the Sayyid Brothers. Jahandarshah fled to Delhi where he was captured and handed over to the new Emperor, who confined him along with Lal Kunwar. He lived in confinement for a month, until 11 February 1713, when professional stranglers were sent to murder him.

13. Consider the following statements:
1. Kitab-i-Nauras, a collection of songs in praise of Hindu deities and Muslim saints, was written by Ibrahim Adil Shah II.
2. Amir Khusrau was the originator in India of the early from of the musical style known as Qawali.
Which of these statements is/are correct?
(a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) both 1 and 2 (d) neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c) : Ibrahim Adilshah was the ruler of Bijapur. He made Hindavi the official language in place of Persian. Ibrahim Adilshah appointed Hindus to various posts. He composed the Hindi song collection Kitab-e-Nauras, which praised Muslim saints and Hindu deities. At this time, Farishta wrote a historical book called 'Tithi-e-Farishta'. The initiator of Qawali was Amir Khusro.

14. How did Sultan Qutb-ud-din Aibak die?
(a) He was treacherously stabbed to death by one of his ambitious nobles.
(b) He was killed in a battle with Taj-u-din Yildiz, the ruler of Ghazni who entered into a contest with him over the capture of Punjab.
(c) He sustained injuries while besieging the fortress of Kalinjar in Bundelkhand and succumbed to them later.
(d) He died after a fall from his horse while playing Chaugan.

Ans. (d) : Qutbuddin Aibak was given authority over Indian territories while returning after Mohammad Ghori took control of Indian territories. Qutbuddin Aibak only assumed the title of 'warlord'. He did not try to mint coins in his own name. In the memory of Qutubuddin Bakhtiyar Kaki, the foundation of Qutub Minar was laid, which was completed by Iltutmish. His capital was Lahore where he died from falling from a horse while playing Chaugan in 1210 AD.

MODERN HISTORY

15. Who headed the Interim Cabinet formed in the year 1946?
(a) Rajendra Prasad
(b) Jawaharlal Nehru
(c) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(d) Rajagopalachari

Ans. (b) : Interim government was formed on September 2, 1946 as per Cabinet mission proposal. It was headed by Jawahar Lal Nehru.

16. The leader of the Bardoli Satyagraha (1928) was :
(a) Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel
(b) Mahatma Gandhi
(c) Vaithalbhai J. Patel
(d) Mahadev Desai

Ans. (a) : Bardoli Satyagraha of 1928, in the state of Gujarat was led by Vallabhbhai Patel. The women of Bardoli gave him the title of Sardar.

17. During the colonial period in India, what was the purpose of the Witley Commission?
(a) To review the fitness of India for further political reforms.
(b) To report on existing conditions of labour and to make recommendations.
(c) To draw up a plan for financial reforms for India.
(d) To develop a comprehensive scheme for Civil Services in India.

Ans. (b) : The Royal Commission on Labour or the Whitley Commission on Labour was set up in 1929 to inquire into the existing conditions of labour in industrial undertakings and plantations in India. The Commission was chaired by John Henry Whitley.

18. With reference to the entry of European powers into India, which one of the following statement in NOT correct?
(a) The Portuguese captures Goa in 1499.
(b) The England opened their first factory in South India at Masulipatam.
(c) In Eastern India, the English Company opened its first factory in Orissa in 1633.
(d) Under the leadership of Dupleix, the French occupied Madras in 1746.

Ans. (a) : The Portuguese conquest of Goa occurred when the governor of Portuguese India, Alfonso de Albuquerque captured the city in 1510. Goa was not among the cities Albuquerque had received orders to conquer: he had only been ordered by the Portuguese king to capture Hormuz, Aden and Malacca.